FREE SELF-ASSESSMENT FROM THE IMPACT PLATFORM

Inclusion Maturity Framework

Find out where your organisation sits today, from Unaware to Leading, across six areas, and leave with prioritised next steps you can take to your leaders.

Self-assessment About 45 minutes Updated October 2026

HOW TO USE THIS

1. Read the five maturity levels so you know what each looks like.
2. Answer the six questions honestly: pick the statement closest to today.
3. Record your level for each area, then find your three lowest.
4. Choose next steps for those three areas and agree them with your leaders.

FILL IT IN ON SCREEN

Open this PDF in Adobe Acrobat Reader (free), Chrome or Edge to fill in and save your work. Previews inside email or on some phones may not let you type, so download it first.

The five maturity levels

From Unaware to Leading, with the signs that you are at each one.

1 Unaware

EDI is not yet on the organisational agenda. There is no dedicated strategy, data is not collected, and responses to inclusion issues are reactive rather than planned. Responsibility sits with no one in particular.

Signs you are at this level

- No EDI strategy or policy exists
- No diversity data is collected or reported
- Inclusion issues are dealt with on a case-by-case basis only
- Leadership has not publicly committed to EDI
- No training or awareness activity takes place

2 Aware

EDI is recognised as important but activity is patchy, uncoordinated, and often driven by one or two individuals rather than the organisation. There are good intentions but limited infrastructure to deliver on them.

Signs you are at this level

- Some EDI activity exists: training days, awareness events, or an EDI champion
- Basic policies are in place but not always enforced
- Some data is collected but not systematically analysed
- Leadership support is present but not visible or consistent
- EDI is seen as separate from core business strategy

3 Developing

A structured approach to EDI is beginning to emerge. Policies are in place, some workforce data is being collected, and there is early leadership buy-in. The challenge is consistency and embedding.

Signs you are at this level

- An EDI strategy or plan exists and is actively worked to
- Diversity data is collected and reported internally
- Training is more systematic, not just one-off events
- An EDI working group or steering committee exists
- Leadership champions are named and visible

4 Embedding

EDI is integrated into core organisational processes rather than existing as a separate workstream. Decisions are informed by data, accountability is clear, and leadership commitment is visible and active.

Signs you are at this level

- EDI objectives sit within individual performance frameworks
- Data is disaggregated and used to drive decisions
- Inclusion is a criterion in recruitment, promotion, and procurement
- Progress is reported externally as well as internally
- EDI budget and resource allocation is formal and protected

5 Leading

EDI is a strategic differentiator. The organisation applies an intersectional lens, drives continuous improvement, and actively influences sector practice. Inclusion is woven into identity and operations at every level.

Signs you are at this level

- Intersectionality is built into data, policy, and programmes
- The organisation benchmarks against external standards and publishes findings
- Leadership actively shapes sector norms through advocacy and sharing
- Employee voice drives strategy, not just informs it
- Continuous improvement loops are embedded and evidenced

Assess six areas

Choose the statement that best describes your organisation today, not where you want to be.

Leadership and Governance

How would you describe your leadership team's engagement with EDI?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** EDI is not discussed at leadership level
- ○ **2. Aware:** Leadership acknowledges EDI but has not committed publicly
- ○ **3. Developing:** At least one senior leader is an active EDI champion
- ○ **4. Embedding:** Leadership sets EDI targets and reviews progress formally
- ○ **5. Leading:** Leadership drives sector-wide change and is externally accountable for EDI

Data and Evidence

How does your organisation collect and use diversity data?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** We do not collect diversity data
- ○ **2. Aware:** We collect some data but do not analyse or act on it
- ○ **3. Developing:** We collect data annually and share results internally
- ○ **4. Embedding:** We use disaggregated data to drive decisions and track progress
- ○ **5. Leading:** We publish intersectional data and use it to benchmark against sector leaders

Policy and Process

How well does your policy and process infrastructure support inclusion?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** We have no specific EDI policies
- ○ **2. Aware:** We have basic equality policies but they are rarely reviewed
- ○ **3. Developing:** Our key policies include an EDI lens and are regularly updated
- ○ **4. Embedding:** EDI criteria are embedded in recruitment, promotion, and procurement processes
- ○ **5. Leading:** All processes are audited through an intersectional inclusion lens on a regular cycle

Culture and Inclusion

How would employees describe the day-to-day culture of inclusion in your organisation?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** Inclusion is not something employees feel confident describing
- ○ **2. Aware:** Some employees feel included but experiences vary widely
- ○ **3. Developing:** Most employees report feeling respected; microaggressions are addressed when raised
- ○ **4. Embedding:** Psychological safety is high; belonging is measured and tracked
- ○ **5. Leading:** The organisation is known externally for its inclusive culture; employees are advocates

Learning and Development

How does your organisation approach EDI learning?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** No EDI training exists
- ○ **2. Aware:** One-off training events have taken place but there is no ongoing provision
- ○ **3. Developing:** Structured EDI training is available to all staff with some mandatory elements
- ○ **4. Embedding:** Learning is role-differentiated, ongoing, and linked to performance
- ○ **5. Leading:** The organisation develops and shares EDI learning resources beyond its own walls

External Engagement

How does your organisation engage with EDI beyond its own workforce?

- ○ **1. Unaware:** No external EDI engagement takes place
- ○ **2. Aware:** The organisation participates in awareness days or campaigns
- ○ **3. Developing:** We have signed at least one external EDI commitment or charter
- ○ **4. Embedding:** We report publicly against benchmarks and engage with EDI networks actively
- ○ **5. Leading:** We co-create sector standards and advocate for systemic change externally

YOUR RESULTS

Write the level number (1 to 5) for each area. Tick your three lowest as focus areas.

Area	Level	Focus area
Leadership and Governance		☐
Data and Evidence		☐
Policy and Process		☐
Culture and Inclusion		☐
Learning and Development		☐
External Engagement		☐

Overall level (add the six numbers, divide by six and round)

Next steps for your focus areas

Tick the steps you will take for your three focus areas.

Leadership and Governance

- [ ] Secure a named executive sponsor for your EDI work
- [ ] Add EDI as a standing agenda item at board and senior leadership meetings
- [ ] Set and publish at least one leadership-level EDI commitment this year

Data and Evidence

- [ ] Launch a voluntary diversity data collection exercise with a clear communication plan
- [ ] Identify which data you already hold and audit its completeness
- [ ] Set a target response rate and report back to employees on findings within 90 days

Policy and Process

- [ ] Audit your top five people policies through an inclusion lens
- [ ] Identify which recruitment and promotion decisions could include explicit EDI criteria
- [ ] Schedule an annual policy review cycle with EDI as a standing consideration

Culture and Inclusion

- [ ] Run a listening exercise or pulse survey focused on belonging and psychological safety
- [ ] Train line managers on responding to microaggressions and disclosures
- [ ] Create a visible reporting route for inclusion concerns that is separate from HR

Learning and Development

- [ ] Map your current EDI learning offer and identify the gaps by role and level
- [ ] Introduce at least one mandatory EDI learning touchpoint for all staff
- [ ] Create a learning pathway for managers that goes beyond awareness to skill-building

External Engagement

- [ ] Identify one external EDI benchmark or charter relevant to your sector
- [ ] Engage with at least one EDI network or community of practice this quarter
- [ ] Consider publishing your diversity data or committing to a transparency report

What we are willing to commit to next

When I will share these results with our leadership team

Why maturity frameworks matter

Inclusion progress is not linear and it is not uniform. Organisations often overestimate their maturity in areas where they feel confident and underestimate the gaps in areas they have not examined. A structured maturity framework provides a shared language for assessing where you are, what good looks like, and what the next step requires.

This framework is designed for honest self-assessment, not for producing a flattering score. The most useful thing you can do with the results is share them with your leadership team and use them as the starting point for a conversation about what you are willing to commit to next.

FROM THE IMPACT PLATFORM

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- The interactive version of this resource, which saves your progress
- More than 40 practical tools, plus learning modules and evidence you can take to your leaders
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